Evoke Technologies

HACKATHON 5.0
EVOHACK 2026

FDE Mode ON

Kickoff: guidelines & evaluation criteria

Thursday, 22 October 2026

THIS YEAR'S THEME

Think like a Forward Deployed Engineer. Deliver like one.



Get close to the problem

Pick a real business problem and do discovery directly with the stakeholder who shared it.



Humans + AI Agents

Whatever your role, tap into every skill by putting AI agents to work.



Deliver an outcome

Ship an AI-powered solution that delivers a measurable result for the business.

THE WEEK AHEAD

Your hackathon journey



01

Discover

22–23 Oct

02

Design

After discovery

03

Build

Until 28 Oct

04

Test & Deploy

Wrap up by 28 Oct

05

Demo & Pitch

Nov, week 1

TODAY · THURSDAY, 22 OCTOBER

Three things to do today

1

3:30pm to 5:30pm

Pick your problem statement

Collect your problem statement chit from the L&D team.

2

BY END OF DAY

Submit your discovery questions

Send the list of questions you need answered by your stakeholder.

3

BY END OF DAY

Share infra requirements

Tell us the infrastructure your solution will need.

STAGE 01 · DISCOVER · 2 DAYS

Discovery happens in two rounds

ROUND 1

22 Oct THU

You submit questions

Your discovery questions, by end of day.

→

23 Oct FRI

You get answers

Answers from your stakeholder, by end of day.

ROUND 2 · OPTIONAL

23 Oct FRI

Ask follow-up questions

Any additional questions, by Friday.

→

26 Oct MON

You get answers

Answers to your follow-ups, by Monday.

INFRASTRUCTURE & TOOLS

Getting your infra and AI tools

EVERYONE

Infrastructure

- Share your requirements by 22 Oct, end of day.
- Infra is provided by Mon, 26 Oct.
- Fill the form shared by the L&D team and share it back with them.

CSC TEAM MEMBERS

VM / VDI access

- Access is given by the IT team.

AI CODING TOOLS

Tool access

- Get your account head's approval on email.
- Send the approval to the Learning team for access.

EVALUATION

Two levels of evaluation

L1

Qualification round

NOV, WEEK 1

- A must-have checklist on your working solution.
- Teams that miss a must-have do not move to Level 2.

L2

Presentation round

NOV, WEEK 1

- Live demo and PPT, scored out of 100 points.
- 30 minutes per team: 20 min demo + 10 min Q&A.

LEVEL 1 · QUALIFICATION

The must-have checklist

Discovery
Questions asked and answers applied.

Agent pipeline
Agents set up across roles, not just code assist.

AI services
AI used inside the solution itself.

Live app demo
A working, deployed prototype.

UI
A usable front end for the flow.

Backend
Working APIs, data and logic.

Testing
Evidence the solution was tested.

Eliminated if: no working prototype, no AI usage evidence, a missed deadline, a major deviation from the problem statement, or non-compliant behaviour.

LEVEL 2 · WHAT TO PREPARE

Your demo and presentation

30

MINUTES PER TEAM

20 min demo | 10 min Q&A

At least one POD member presents.

YOUR PRESENTATION MUST COVER, IN THIS ORDER

1. Discovery insights & the key problem
2. Solution approach & architecture diagram
3. AI agents used
4. Quality, validation & security
5. Metrics & business impact
6. Future scope
7. Live demo: show it running on AI, end to end

LEVEL 2 · PRESENTATION ROUND

Scored out of 100 points

Solution Design & Functional Completeness Core workflows run end to end on a well-designed, tested and secure build.	DEMO + PPT		25
Technical Creativity, Problem-Solving & UX Smart trade-offs, intuitive flow. Runs on AI, or still depends on individuals?	LIVE DEMO		15
AI-First Delivery An agent pipeline from business analysis to user adoption, not just AI writing code.	PPT		30
Problem Fit & Business Outcome Think like a consultant: frame the problem, propose the fix, prove the ROI.	PPT		20
Communication, Impact & Future Scope Pitch to the audience we set for you: clear story, confident Q&A, next steps.	PPT		10

EVALUATION · THE FDE LENS

How an FDE solves the problem

SEE
Understand the system
15%

DECONSTRUCT
Name the real problem
20%

REFRAME
Design the outcome
20%

BUILD
A working slice
20%

PROVE
Show the evidence
20%

Customer story: tie it all together for the customer. **5%**

DELIVERABLES

What you submit, and when



Discovery questions
Your list of questions for the stakeholder.

22 OCT / 23 OCT · EOD



Source code
Pushed to the designated GitHub repository.

BY 29 OCT



Working solution
Deployed and running for evaluation.

BY 29 OCT



AI usage logs
Agent logs in your repo.

BY 29 OCT



Presentation deck
Shared with the judging panel.

PRESENTATION DAY

YOUR SPOCS

Who to reach out to

AI-RELATED QUERIES

L&D Team

Anything about AI tools, agents or approaches.

DISCOVERY & THE EVENT

L&D team

Discovery questions and anything about the hackathon.

INFRA, VDI & VM ACCESS

Satya Kolli & IT team

Keep the Learning team in the loop. Teams group created for any support.

Questions?

Pick up your problem statement today, 3:30PM – 5:30PM.

Smarter Teams. Bigger Impact.